



The Trinity Urban Forest project by the class of Climate Entrepreneurs 2024.



Insert 1 verse of a poem.

Conor and Andre setup Urban Forest.ie to promote biodiversity and community climate action. Having completed Climate Entrepreneurship PG at TCD in 2024, the class were motivated to complete a project that would educate and inspire others to help increase biodiversity in Trinity. Catherine Cleary had already started a 'pocket forest' using the **Miyawaki method** to accelerate growth of trees and shrubs and we were inspired and decided to extend the mini forest by preparing and planting a further 30m². Trinity provided 50% of the funding and the class raised the other half of funding through a GoFundme campaign. The trees were sourced from the not-for-profit group Sonairte, (which is derived from an Irish word meaning 'positive strength') based in Laytown Co. Meath. The location of the urban forest is in front of

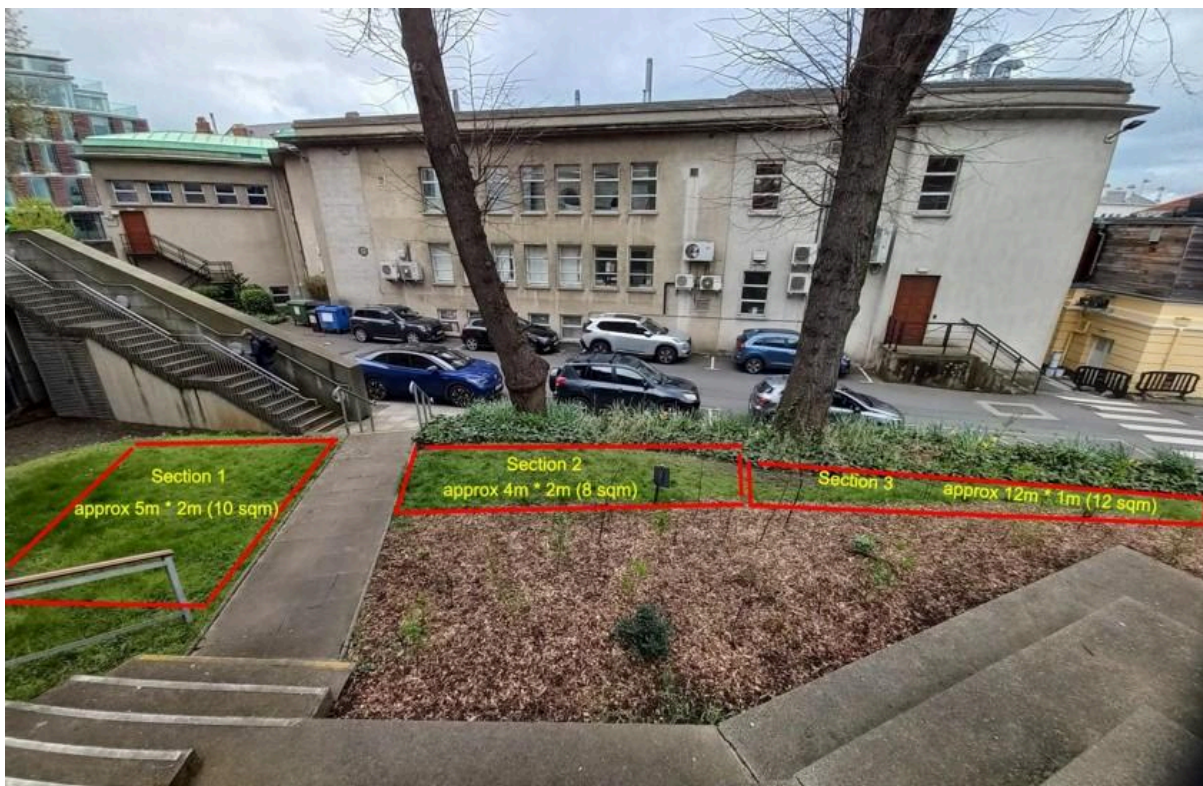
--	--	--



Parson's Hall, the dept. of Mechanical, Manufacturing and Biomedical Engineering building, Trinity College Dublin.

The Miyawaki Method: This technique, of planting native trees and shrubs very close together and developing this competitive ecosystem, was developed by Akikira Miyawaki in 1970s. The concept is that the planting density creates a network of roots in the undersoil resulting in a web structure with many benefits, providing nutrients and water to the trees and shrubs that need it most. Above ground the tightly packed trees and shrubs compete for light resulting in increased stretching. The results can be astonishing where it has been seen that trees can grow 10 times faster and the biodiversity of the soil can be up to 100 times more diverse than conventional planting. A good example of this method is explained on a Ted talk that can be found at https://www.ted.com/talks/shubhendu_sharma_an_engineer_s_vision_for_tiny_forests_everywhere?utm_campaign=tedsread&utm_medium=referral&utm_source=tcdcomshare

Before: The area of over 30m² was in grass which we planned in three sections.





The prep: The ground was prepared by John Parnell, Conor Davis and Andre Baumann, by spreading 90kg of **coffee grinds**, donated by Poppies café, to the 30m² area on November 4th 2024. This was followed by covering the area with **cardboard** and then loading 3 tons of **mulch**.

The native trees and shrubs were sourced from Sonairte.ie in Co. Meath.

Shrubs: Hawthorn, Blackthorn, Dog Rose & Spindle

Trees: Alder, Hazel, Silver Birch and Rowan



The Planting: The planting took place on December 13th

Insert picture of team planting + pic with Jane Hackett and John Parnell

--	--	--

